Anthropic Report

File Edit View Insert Format Tools Extensions Help

Share

100% Normal text Arial 11

Case Study Report

Ireland and the AI Supply Chain: Anthropic's Dublin Expansion

MSc Digital Innovation | UCD Michael Smurfit Graduate Business School | April 2026

1. Introduction

Ireland has quickly become an important node in the global artificial intelligence (AI) ecosystem. This case study looks at why Anthropic chose Dublin as the location for its EMEA headquarters, placing that decision within Ireland's wider role as a major European tech hub. Using publicly available company data and materials from the launch of Anthropic's Dublin office, the case study explores the key factors that make Ireland appealing to frontier AI firms, as well as the economic and organisational impact of this expansion.

2. Why Ireland?: Ireland's Strategic Position in the AI Supply Chain

Ireland's rise as a go-to location for global tech companies is not by accident, it is built on a convergent set of structural advantages. One of the biggest draws is talent. The IMF has ranked Ireland first in the world for skill readiness, and it produces more STEM graduates per capita among 20-29 year-olds than any other EU country (IDA Ireland, 2026). For AI companies, where everything from model training to safety research depends heavily on highly skilled people, this steady pipeline of talent is a major asset.

Ireland is also home to 16 of the world's top 20 technology firms, with companies like Meta, Google, LinkedIn, and Airbnb all running their European headquarters out of Dublin (IDA Ireland, 2026). This concentration makes it much easier for newer entrants to hire experienced workers, build partnerships, and connect with established business networks.

On the regulatory side, Ireland offers a unique combination, full access to the EU single market, alongside an English–speaking legal and business environment, which is relatively rare within the EU. Add to that a pro-innovation policy setup, grounded in GDPR compliance, a 12.5% corporate tax rate, generous R&D tax credits, and long-term strategies like the government's Digital and AI 2030 plan, and it is clear why AI firms see Ireland as a practical and strategic base for expansion (IDA Ireland, 2026).

3. The Anthropic Dublin Case